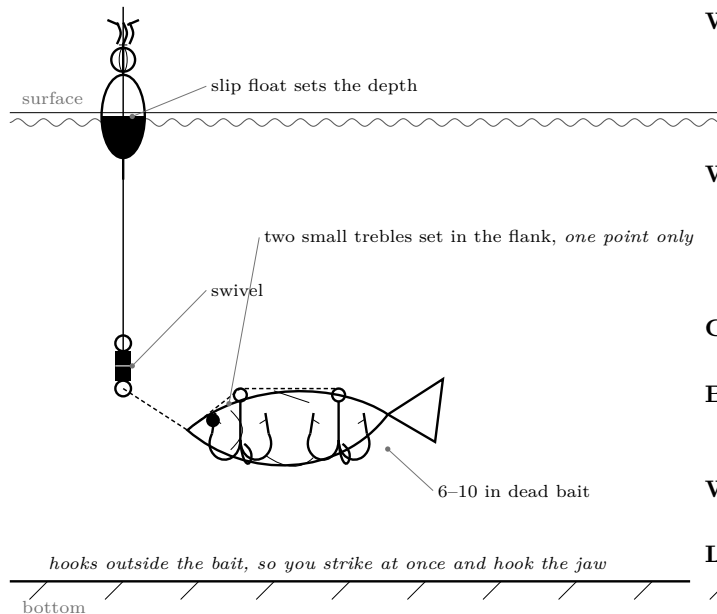


Quick-Strike Rig

Fish a big dead bait for pike and hook the fish, not its stomach



What it does	Two small treble hooks set into the flank of a large dead bait, on a wire trace. Because the hooks are on the <i>outside</i> of the bait, you strike immediately instead of waiting for the pike to swallow.
Why it matters	The old method — a single hook inside a bait, and a long wait — gut-hooks pike and kills fish you meant to release. A quick-strike rig hooks them in the jaw. This is the humane way to do it, and it is also more effective.
Components	Wire trace with two size 6–8 trebles, barrel swivel, slip float and stop, large dead bait.
Bait	A dead sucker, smelt or large shiner, 6–10 in. Dead bait works: pike scavenge readily, especially in cold water.
Wire	Not optional. Pike teeth cut monofilament instantly.
Line	20 lb braid or 15 lb mono; a rod with backbone.

Build and bait it

1. Rig the **slip float** on the main line — stop knot, bead, float — exactly as on the *see the slip bobber sheet* sheet. Set the depth so the bait hangs just above the weed tops.
2. Tie the main line to a **barrel swivel**, and the swivel to the **wire trace**.
3. Set the **rear treble** into the bait's flank near the tail, one point only, barely under the skin.
4. Set the **front treble** near the head, again one point only. The bait should hang naturally, not bent.

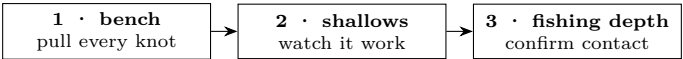
Fish it

Strike early	When the float goes down, count to five , reel until tight, and sweep hard. Do not give it a minute. Do not give it thirty seconds. The whole design assumes an early strike.
Tackle at hand	Long-nose pliers, side cutters and jaw spreaders in the boat before you cast, not after you hook one.
Cut, do not dig	If a hook is awkward, cut the treble with side cutters and back the pieces out. A cheap hook is worth less than the fish.
Where	Pine spots 1 and 9 in April and again in October; the deep weed edge at 5 in summer. North spots 2 , 5 and 6 .
Ice	The same rig on a tip-up is the standard big-pike presentation, <i>see the tip-up sheet</i> .

HANDLE PIKE PROPERLY

Backward-facing teeth, and a fish strong enough to thrash while you work. Jaw spreaders and long pliers every time; fingers never inside the mouth or under the gill plate. Pike over 70 °F water are fragile — unhook in the net, in the water, and release quickly. See the **Northern Pike** sheet.

Prove the rig



- Bench test

With hook covers on, pull every crimp and wire connection; set the two trebles the measured distance apart for the bait.
- Water test

Suspend the dead bait beside the hole: it must hang horizontal, with both hook points exposed and the float carrying the load.
- Proof at depth

The float cocks consistently at the stop and the bait remains above weed, not buried in it.
- If it fails

Bait hangs nose-down: move the front hook toward the head. Float sinks: increase capacity. Never fish if a crimp slips under a hard hand pull. Change one variable, repeat the same cast or drop, and keep the first setting that restores the expected proof.

Record the adjustment

Try	Depth / distance	Sink count	Observed action	Fish response	Next single change
1					
2					
3					

Questions before another cast

Did the rig reach the intended depth? What visible line, rod-tip, bottom, or lure response proves that? Did the connection and hook point survive the retrieve? Was a follow, bite, snag, or refusal observed rather than assumed? Name one variable to change and one to hold constant. If the observation cannot answer those questions, repeat the same short controlled cast before changing the setup.

☐ Sketch the cast: surface, cover, target depth, line angle, and where the response occurred

Evidence-based verdict

☐ repeat unchanged

☐ alter one variable

☐ retire or repair the rig

Reason and next prediction

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